

Jeffrey's Challah

PREP 35 mins

BAKE 25 to 30 mins

TOTAL 4 hrs 30 mins

YIELD 2 large or 3 medium loaves

Ingredients

Dough

- 3 large (46g) egg yolks
- 3 large (150g) whole eggs
- 1/3 cup (66g) vegetable oil
- 1 1/3 cups (302g) cold water
- 7 3/4 cups (934g) King Arthur Unbleached All-Purpose Flour
- 1/2 cup (99g) sugar
- 1 tablespoon (18g) salt
- 1 tablespoon + 2 1/2 teaspoons (17g) instant yeast

Topping

- 1 large egg (50g)
- 1 teaspoon water
- poppy or sesame seeds, optional

Instructions

liquid ingredients in bowl first so flour doesn't stick!

- ① Place all of the dough ingredients into a large bowl (or the bowl of your stand mixer) in the order in which they're listed. Mix just until the dough comes together to form a shaggy mass; using your mixer equipped with the dough hook, this will take about 3 minutes on low speed.
- ② Knead the dough, by hand or mixer, until it's smooth and well-developed; this will take 5 to 6 minutes at medium speed using your mixer. *low speed 8 min
med speed 2 min **
- ③ Cover the bowl with plastic wrap or a reusable cover and allow the dough to rise at room temperature for 1 hour. Refrigerate the dough for 1 hour, or until it's thoroughly chilled. *-or overnight*
- ④ Remove the dough from the refrigerator, and transfer it to a lightly greased work surface. To make two large loaves, divide the dough in half; each half will weigh about 824g. Note: For three smaller loaves see "tips," below. *strand 549g dough - 3 braids*
- ⑤ Working with one piece of dough at a time, divide it into three, four, or six pieces (to make a standard braid, a four-strand braid, or a six-strand braid). To make the six-strand braid pictured above, divide into six pieces, each about 137g. Preshape each piece into a rough log; you're going to be rolling them into long strands. Cover the logs. Repeat with the remaining piece of dough, dividing it into six pieces (or however many you need for the braid you want to make).
- ⑥ Let the covered logs relax for about 20 minutes.
- ⑦ Uncover the logs. Working with the dough for one loaf, roll each log into a strand about 20" long. Make a six-strand braid; for help with this technique, check out our video:
- ⑧ Repeat to make the second loaf.
- ⑨ Place each loaf on a parchment-lined or lightly greased baking sheet. Cover the loaves and let them rise at room temperature until they're almost doubled in size, about 1 1/2 to 2 hours.

* if mixer starts to get warm, turn off & let rest 10 min.
med speed is just #2

- watch King Arthur's Isolation Baker Baking Show #4